

HAIYU ZHANG

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EDUCATION

M.S. Learning, Design & Technology · Stanford University

Aug 2024 – Dec 2025

Certified Mental Health Coach (CMHC) · Headspace Training Institute

Sep 2023 – May 2024

Dual B.A. in Information Science & Comparative Literature · Columbia University

Sep 2021 – Jun 2024

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Workshop Facilitator · Headspace Training Institute

Jan 2026 – Present

- Facilitated evidence-based bibliotherapy workshops for mental health practitioners; designed curriculum with clinical supervisor integrating therapeutic reading frameworks, Motivational Interviewing (MI), and responsible AI principles into structured group and individual training experiences, building practical bridges between clinical knowledge and AI-powered mental health product delivery.
- Progressed through a rigorous clinical pathway (Intern → Coach Trainee → Certified Mental Health Coach → Facilitator); applied C-SSRS risk assessment protocols, SMART goal-setting, and MI across coaching and product context to ensure responsible care delivery at every stage.

Product Engineer · Zuntold

Feb 2026 – Present

- Lead engineer for [Zuntold](#), a bibliotherapy platform. Architected and shipped a full-stack, production-grade immersive reading product from zero, working cross-functionally with bibliotherapists and stakeholders to translate therapeutic reading guidelines into AI-enabled experiences.
- Defined clinical guardrails, acceptance criteria, and QA evaluation frameworks for AI-assisted content delivery; designed clinically informed UX patterns—dyslexia-friendly presets, adaptive pacing, crisis-aware escalation pathways, ensuring AI interactions align with safety, efficacy, and best practices across all clinical deployments and user-facing interventions.
- Contributed to conversational prompt design and clinical policy layers; advocated for responsible AI use in mental health, balancing innovation with clinical rigor, hallucination mitigation safeguards, and ethical governance standards.
- Instrumented the platform with session-level analytics and user behavior telemetry to evaluate clinical engagement and AI interaction quality; used data-driven insights to iteratively refine therapeutic content delivery, reading pacing algorithms, and intervention timing, creating a feedback loop between real-world clinical usage and product improvement.

Founder & Lead Engineer · Shh-elf — AI Book Recommendation & Mental Health [\[demo\]](#)

Aug 2024 – Present

- Founded and shipped a full-stack AI app (Python/FastAPI, GPT, ElevenLabs, RAG) transforming personalized book recommendations into emotionally engaging 30-second audio experiences; won Stanford Learning Challenge Award (\$3K, Top 3 of 20+ teams), demonstrating product-market fit at the intersection of AI and mental health literacy.
- Designed intelligent recommendation pipeline using Semantic Search, SFT, RLHF, and RAG to improve clinical-grade match accuracy; built evaluation metrics, analytics infrastructure, and prompt design layers to monitor AI safety, content personalization, and therapeutic content efficacy, incorporating user feedback loops to refine model outputs and strengthen clinical alignment.

Teaching Facilitator & Life Coach · Stanford Life Design Lab

Mar – Dec 2025

- Co-designed and delivered ‘Design for Your Spiritual Life,’ integrating contemplative science, ACT, and life design frameworks; facilitated small-group and 1-on-1 coaching sessions helping a diverse student population explore purpose, resilience, and long-term behavioral change.
- Developed accessible clinical content translating complex behavioral psychology into practical reflective exercises; ensured tone, escalation pathways, and intervention design aligned with evidence-based mental health best practices for a diverse and underserved student population.

LLM Product Management Intern · Kunlun AI

Jul 2024 – Sep 2024

- Led team of 9 to optimize the Linky LLM platform; drove paid conversion 2.14% → 5.82% (+230%) and chapter completion 10% → 30% in two weeks via prompt engineering, 25+ user interviews, and UX refinement; improved content generation efficiency 70% through human-AI workflow redesign, directly informing the platform’s long-term monetization strategy and product-market fit roadmap.
- Led AI safety and ethics investigation for sensitive-content on [Linky](#), auditing outputs and user flows to identify risks (e.g., NSFW boundaries, consent, misuse), and translating findings into guardrails and moderation strategies.

Product Management Intern · Headspace

Jun – Sep 2023

- Led cross-functional team of 3 to redesign content revisitation UX; conducted 16 user interviews and Amplitude behavioral analysis to surface clinical user needs and translate them into actionable product requirements; iterated Figma prototypes and presented findings to leadership.
- Designed a mental health gamification system—the ‘flourishing tree model’—mapping users’ inner well-being journey; collaborated with product and clinical teams to align AI-driven coaching features with evidence-based therapeutic principles and engagement strategies.

LLM Researcher · MIT Media Lab & Columbia Digital Storytelling Lab

Feb – Jun 2023

- Collaborated with MIT Fluid Interfaces Group to build a VR nightmare-transformation tool (C#), applying statistical user testing to improve therapeutic outcomes; led a dream analysis workshop at Lincoln Center; featured in the [New York Times](#) for contributions to digital storytelling and mental health, demonstrating the potential of AI-immersive tools in evidence-based therapeutic settings.

Software Engineer Intern · Google

May – Aug 2022

- Co-created a mental health support app (Java, JS, Google Maps API) for mood logging and therapist discovery; collaborated with NY State Psychiatric Institute on a VR Cyberball game studying schizophrenia eye-movement patterns, achieving 27.8% improvement in group differentiation accuracy, advancing clinical research into AI applications for psychiatric assessment.

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Clinical: Certified Mental Health Coach · C-SSRS Assessment · Motivational Interviewing · CBT · Bibliotherapy · SMART Goal-Setting

AI / Technical: LLMs · Prompt Engineering · RAG · RLHF · SFT · NLP · Hallucination Mitigation · Python · FastAPI · Figma · Amplitude

Regulatory: HIPAA · AI Safety & Ethics · Clinical Governance · Risk Classification · Responsible AI in Mental Health